

an Resource Information System) Workday, on the Job tab page, in the Equal Employment Opportunity section, we have a field titled Protected Veteran Status that we ask our US-based team members to complete during the onboarding process. The reason we ask is because it is a legal requirement in the United States for us to request this information. We encourage GitLab team members to self-disclose in our HRIS without any fear of judgment or negative consequences, but it is always optional. All veteran status data is completely confidential, and only requested for mandatory reporting purposes.

The options of this field are:

- Yes, I am a US Veteran with a Protected Status
- Not Applicable
- Prefer Not to Answer

Above this field, we have a section titled Veteran Status that we ask our US-based team members to review and also complete during the onboarding process, if it applies to them and if they so wish. The reason we ask is because it is a legal requirement in the United States for us to request and document this information. We encourage our US-based GitLab team members to self-disclose their Veteran Status in our HRIS without any fear of judgment or negative consequences, but it is always optional. Again, all veteran status data is completely confidential, and only requested for mandatory reporting purposes.

If you are a team member on a GitLab Inc or Federal contract and a disabled veteran you may request a "reasonable accommodation." A reasonable accommodation is one that allows you to perform your job, and must be provided by GitLab unless doing so would cause GitLab significant difficulty or expense. A reasonable accommodation does not change essential job functions. GitLab can choose the type of reasonable accommodation that will be made available; however, the accommodation must be effective. More information on how to request a reasonable accommodation is available [here](#). Please review the reasonable accommodation handbook section if you would like an accommodation due to your veteran status.

Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging Learning & Development

- TBD

Process for learning material and course creators

Team members who might use this process include: DIB and L&D team members, managers creating training for their teams, departments creating required compliance training, team members creating training for their peers or community, Developer Relations creating training for the wider GitLab community

1. When a new training is created or curated open up an issue using the following template. It is best to open this issue as soon as you've begun building out the learning material so that the DIB and L&D team can provide early guidance
 1. Assign the issue to a DIB Team Member and a L&D team member - the assignees must not be someone who participated in creating or curating the training
 1. The assignees will go through the content of the training and complete the QA process as outlined in the issue.
 1. The content creator and assignees will use the issue to collaborate on and document

improvements made to the content that align with quality check list above

1. When all 3 participants agree that the course has met our inclusion and learning standards, close the issue and proceed with adding the materials or course to GitLab Learn

Community

GitLab team members are distributed across the globe, giving us access to an array of opportunity.

We encourage collaboration with global organizations and programs that support underrepresented individuals in the tech industry.

GitLab also provides additional support through the GitLab Diversity Sponsorship program.

We offer funds to help support the event financially, and if the event is in a city we have a GitLab team member, we get hands-on by offering to coach and/or give a talk whenever possible.

We encourage organizers of events that are supported through our GitLab Diversity Sponsorship program to share this sign up link with attendees. Everyone can contribute.

Definitions

- Gender and Sexual Orientation Identity Definitions and FAQ
- Leadership is defined as director and above.
- Geographically is defined as those countries we use in our identity data.
- Women is the term GitLab uses instead of "Female". "Female/Male" are gender terms often designated at birth. "Woman/Man" are gender terms based on self-identification. At GitLab, we define women based on how team members self-identify their gender in Workday.
- Race - To understand our representation, we want to do our best in having categories for race that team members can select where they are able to in some way identify with the options available. These definitions align with the EEOC:
 - American Indian or Alaska Native - A person having origins in any of the original peoples of North and South America (including Central America) and who maintains tribal affiliation or community attachment. This category includes people who indicate their race as American Indian, Alaska Native, Navajo, Blackfeet, Inupiat, Yup'ik, Central American Indian groups or South American Indian groups.
 - Asian - A person having origins in any of the original peoples of the Far East, Southeast Asia, or the Indian subcontinent including but not limited to: Cambodia, China, India, Japan, Korea, Malaysia, Pakistan, the Philippine Islands, Thailand, and Vietnam. This includes people who indicate their race as Asian Indian, Chinese, Filipino, Korean, Japanese, Vietnamese and or other not mentioned Asian identifies.
 - Black - A person having origins in any of the Black racial groups of Africa. Including people who indicate their race as Black or African American, Cape Coloreds, Caribbean, Kenyan, Nigerian, or Haitian.
 - Hispanic or LatinX - A person of Cuban, Mexican, Puerto Rican, South or Central American, or other Spanish culture or origin, regardless of race. The term, "Spanish origin", can be used in addition to "Hispanic or Latino". Although not of Spanish-origin, Brazil is also included in this category due its inclusion in the LatinX definition.
 - Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander - A person having origins in any of the original people of Hawaii, Guam, Samoa, or other Pacific Islands. Included but not limited to people who reported their race as Fijian, Guamanian, Chamorro, Marshallese, Native Hawaiian, Samoan, Tongan or other Pacific Islander.
 - Multiracial - refers to two or more races as described in the listed categories.

- White - A person having origins in any of the original people of Europe, the Middle East, or North Africa. Included but not limited to people who indicate their race as: White, Irish, German, Italian, Lebanese, Arab, Moroccan, or Caucasian.
- Ethnicity: Can be more broadly defined as "large groups of people classed according to common racial, national, tribal, religious, linguistic, or cultural origin or background."
 - For example people who are Black/African Descent can have a variety of ethnicities such as African, African American, Afro-Caribbean, Afro-Latinx etc. Whilst physical characteristics can be similar there could be cultural differences.
- Underrepresented Group This can be defined as a group whose percentage of the population in a given group is lower than their percentage of the population of country, community, organization or otherwise.
 - An example of this at GitLab is: Women within Senior Leadership is still low compared to Men within Senior Leadership. Which meant that GitLab created the goal of 50% of all senior leadership should be women by December 2021 to address the imbalance within this underrepresented group.
- TMRG (Team Member Resource Group) - In other organizations, a TMRG can be an ERG (Employee Resource Group). TMRGs are voluntary, team member-led groups focused on fostering diversity, inclusion and belonging within GitLab. These groups help team members build stronger internal and external connections; offer social, educational, and outreach activities; create development opportunities for future leaders; and increase engagement among team members.
- Ally - A diversity, inclusion and belonging "ally" is someone who is willing to take action in support of another person, in order to remove barriers that impede that person from contributing their skills and talents in the workplace or community.
- Allyship - Is the state of being an ally, supporting or being a member of groups or associations of the people you are an ally too. An example of this is someone who does not identify as part of the LGBTQI+ community being a part of the TMRG and supporting the endeavors.
- Unconscious bias - Unconscious biases are stereotypes about certain groups of people that individuals form outside their own conscious awareness.

Nearly all our thoughts and actions are influenced, at least in part, by unconscious impulses. There's no reason bias should be out of scope. Categorizing people based on social and other characteristics is a powerful survival mechanism, as it helps to distinguish friends from foes and make quick "life or death" decisions based on "inner feeling". At the same time this is a fertile ground for growing stereotypes, prejudice, discrimination.
- Psychological safety - is defined by Amy Edmondson as a "shared belief held by members of a team that the team is safe for interpersonal risk taking".

It's not about being warm and fuzzy and sharing your feelings. It's about being comfortable admitting when you are wrong or have made a mistake as well as challenging each other for the better.

Performance Indicators

SECTION: company/culture/inclusion/advisory-group-members.md

{{< group-by-expertise "Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging Advisory Group" >}}

What is an ally?

A diversity, inclusion and belonging "ally" is someone who is willing to take action in support of another person, in order to remove barriers that impede that person from contributing their skills and talents in the workplace or community.

Being an ally is a verb, this means that you proactively and purposefully take action and is not something forced upon you.

How to be an ally

It is not required to be an ally to work at GitLab. At GitLab it is required to be inclusive.

Being an ally goes a step beyond being inclusive to taking action to support marginalized groups. The first step in being an ally is self-educating.

This ally lab will provide you with some of the tools, resources and learning activities to help you grow as an ally.

Skills and Behaviors of allies

To be an effective ally it is important to understand some of the skills and behaviors great allies exhibit.

- Active listening
 - Neutral and nonjudgmental.
 - Patient (periods of silence are not "filled")
 - Verbal and nonverbal feedback to show signs of listening (e.g., smiling, eye contact, leaning in, mirroring)
 - Asking questions.
 - Reflecting back what is said.
 - Asking for clarification.
 - Summarizing.
- Empathy & Emotional Intelligence
 - An example of this could be: A colleague comes to you and tells you that their pronouns are being misused often at work and it is making them feel uncomfortable and they are avoiding social calls and interactions. Whilst you haven't experienced this yourself and unlikely you would experience this, you allow yourself to think of situations where you have felt uncomfortable at work before. You also put yourself consciously into the shoes of your colleague and think of a way you can practically help. You offer to your colleague that in the next 5 calls they participate in you will be on the call and actively point out misuse of their pronouns to other colleagues to take away some of the emotional burden.
- Active learning about other experiences
 - You go beyond performative actions for example black squares on Instagram for Black Lives Matter, but actively does the work to understand the pain, struggle and experience of those burdened.
 - This could look like: You are managing black team members, an incident has occurred externally that could affect the mental health of those team members. You actively research the

experience and historical context of the trauma associated with the incident. You use this to ensure you are informed and able to appropriately apply empathy if a team member approaches you to ask for assistance.

- Humility

- Non-defensive
- Willingness to take on feedback
- You aren't going to get it right all the time and you have to be ok with that. Be willing to take feedback on and not let it deter you from continuing to be an ally.

- Example of this could be: You are in a safe space with an underrepresented group acting as an ally and absorbing information. A point comes up that you are passionate about and you talk over someone in the group and take over the conversation. After the meeting someone from the group jumps on a Zoom meeting with you and explains that it felt you took away the viewpoints of a number of people from the URG because you took over the conversation and interrupted an individual. You apologize, take on the feedback, ask for any tips on how to make sure it doesn't happen again and take the necessary steps. --- One of the mistakes that often happens here is being defensive or justifying the action. The group will already know you are operating with good intent but generally are wanting to help you level up in their lived experience.

- Courage

- Comfortable getting uncomfortable
- Speak up where others don't or can't
- The empathy example is also a good example of this.

- Self-awareness

- Own and use your privilege
- This could look like: You are in a product meeting and the meeting will be making critical decisions about the product roadmap for the next three months and you notice that everyone in the meeting is of the same gender and race. You use your privileged situation in the meeting to point this out and ask the people in the meeting. Who should be invited to ensure we are getting a diverse perspective and viewpoint on the agenda items for the meeting?

- Action orientated

- You see something, you say something
- The example above is a good example of this: Ensure decisions and conversations have diverse voices. I.E. you are in a meeting and everyone looks the same, insist on other perspectives.

- In a group setting when a discussion or comment is verbalized that could be controversial use language similar to this to course correct the conversation:

- - "I would like us all to be aware of our language and/or acknowledgements and ensure we are being respectful to all individuals. Thank you."

- - "I am practicing being an ally and as a reminder I would like to ensure we are all using inclusive language"

What it means to be an ally

- Take on the struggle as your own
- Stand up, even when you feel uncomfortable
- Transfer the benefits of your privilege to those who lack it
- Acknowledge that while you, too, feel pain, the conversation is not about you

Concepts & Terms

1. Privilege: an unearned advantage given to some people but not all

- 1. Oppression: systemic inequality present throughout society that benefits people with more privilege and is a disadvantage to those with fewer privileges
- 1. Ally: a member of a social group that has some privilege, that is working to end oppression and understands their own privilege
- 1. Power: The ability to control circumstances or access to resources and/or privileges
- 1. Marginalized groups: a person or group that are treated as unimportant, insignificant or of lower status. In a workplace setting, employees could be treated as invisible, as if they aren't there or their skills or talents are unwelcome or unnecessary
- 1. Performative allyship: referring to allyship that is done to increase a person's social capital rather than because of a person's devotion to a cause. For example some people used metoo during the Me Too movement, without actually bringing more awareness or trying to effect change.

Tips on being an ally

- 1. Identifying your power and privilege helps you act as an ally more effectively
- 1. Follow and support those as much as possible from marginalized groups
- 1. When you make a mistake, apologize, correct yourself, and move on
- 1. Allies spend time educating themselves and use the knowledge to help
- 1. Allies take the time to think and analyze the situation
- 1. Allies try to understand Perception vs. Reality
- 1. Allies don't stop with their power they also leverage others powers of authority

See our Ally Resources Page for more resources on being an ally.

Allyship & Empathy

Being an Ally Requires Empathy

{{< youtube "1Ewgu369Jw" >}}

Responding with Empathy

What to say, when you don't know what to say:

- Acknowledgement of their pain.
"I'm sorry you are going through this." "That must be hard."
- Share how you feel.
"Wow. I don't know what to say." "It makes me really sad to hear this happened."
- Show Gratitude that the person opened up.
"Thank you for sharing with me." "This must be hard to talk about. Thanks for opening up to me."
- Show Interest.
"How are you feeling about everything?" "Is there anything else you want to share?"
- Be Encouraging.
"You are brave / strong / talented." "You matter."
- Be Supportive.
"I'm here for you." "I'm happy to listen any time."

Boot and Sandal Methophor

Imagine you are wearing a heavy boot (represents privilege) and you are stepping on someone's foot that is only wearing sandals (represents oppression). If someone says, "Ouch, you are stepping on my toes!" How do you react?

Problems with common responses to mistakes become obvious:

- Centering the mistake around yourself: "I can't believe you think I'm a toe-stepper! I'm a good person!"
- Denial that others' experiences are different from your own: "I don't mind when people step on my toes."
- Derailing: "Some people don't even have toes, why aren't we talking about them instead?"
- Refusal to center the impacted: "All toes matter!"
- Tone policing: "I'd move my foot if you'd ask me more nicely."
- Denial that the problem is fixable: "Toes getting stepped on is a fact of life. You'll be better off when you accept that."
- Victim blaming: "You shouldn't have been walking around people with boots!"
- Withdrawing: "I thought you wanted my help, but I guess not. I'll just go home."

Instead, you would respond with the following:

- Center the impacted: "Are you okay?"
- Listen to their response and learn.
- Apologize for the impact, even though you didn't intend it: "I'm sorry!"
- Stop the instance: move your foot
- Stop the pattern: be careful where you step in the future. When it comes to oppression, we want to actually change the "footwear" to get rid of privilege and oppression (sneakers for all!), but metaphors can only stretch so far!

Improve allyship skills by following the three C's

- Consciousness
- Courage
- Compassion

How diversity shows up on teams

Image

Areas you can show allyship

Recruiting & Hiring

- Sourcing
- Interviewing
- Compensation

Guidance & Support

- Helping through challenges
- Listening and empathizing

- Providing perspective
- Mentorship

Difficult Conversations

- Performance conversations
- Ongoing feedback

Growth & Career Development

- Career planning
- Skill development
- Mentorship and sponsorship

Examples of Allyship at GitLab

TBC

Ally Lab Learning Group

{{< youtube "dPywm-j1iic" >}}

The Ally Lab Learning Group is an initiative to learn to become or be a better ally within a collaborative group of peers who are seeking the same aim of allyship growth. All team members have the ability to be an ally whether you are a part of an underrepresented group (URG) or not, there are URGs that may not belong to and you have the ability to be an ally to them. There will be regular intakes of team members into groups.

The next intake: You can sign up here

To sign up: TBC

The Group:

- ALLG Facilitator
- 5-10 team members
- Diversity within the group where self-identification is available

What you will need:

- The ability to have 1 synchronous 30-45min a week (Timezone convenient location)
- A higher intent to become an ally

What you will do:

1. Session 1: Async ally training and courses. Synchronous meeting to discuss what you have learned.

1. Explore Ally Allyship
1. Cultivate Equality at Work
1. Communicating with Empathy

- 1. Effective Listening
- 1. Building Trust
- 1. The importance of trust
- 1. How to engage meaningfully in allyship and anti-racism - OPTIONAL
- 1. Inclusive mindset of committed allies - OPTIONAL
- 1. Session 2: The importance of being an ally and why you want to be an ally.
- 1. Session 3: Work as a group to discuss a number of scenarios and how to tackle them as an ally.
- 1. Session 4: Together, write a commitment to allyship and the values you will abide by to be an ally.
 - 1. In the last session you will decide as a group a short commitment statement that should be shared on the Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging Sharing Page. Think about what you have individually and collectively learnt during the experience.

Create 2-5 values that, as a group, you will hold in your continuous learning in allyship and take into account when situations arise.

Once completed you now have a safe group to discuss allyship with, either to get advice, hold yourself accountable to or run through a situation. Things you can do post the 4 week ALLG:

- Schedule a quarterly or bi-yearly call with your group
- Ask members of your group for regular coffee chats to discuss the above
- Reflect regularly on your commitment and values you agreed to and situations where you could have displayed allyship

Ally Training

We held a 50 minute Live Learning Ally Training on 2020-01-28. The recording follows along with the slide deck and agenda.

{{< youtube "wwZeFjDc4zE" >}}

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</figure>
```

External Ally Training

There are some essential skills that are required to be an ally, here are a number of trainings that will help you enhance your allyship skills. Some of these are not allyship specific but will sharpen your skills in those important areas.

- Equality Ally Strategies
- Champion Workplace Equality
- Effective Listening
- How to engage meaningfully in Allyship
- Becoming a true ally

- Building Trust
- Why trust matters

Ally Learning Activity and Scenarios

GitLab Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging resources

Allies familiarize themselves with GitLab's general DIB content

- Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging page
- Gender and Sexual Orientation Identity Definitions and FAQ
- DIB training resources
- Unconscious bias

Ally Resources

Here are additional resources on being an ally

- Guide to allyship
- 5 Tips For Being An Ally
- Ally skills workshop. Check out the materials section with a handout PDF (linking to many more resources), slides PDF, videos, and more.
- Why cisgender allies should put pronouns on their name tag

SECTION: company/culture/inclusion/being-inclusive.md

What is fundamental for a successful inclusive environment

We are all responsible for creating and maintaining an inclusive environment at GitLab.

We all need to feel empowered to contribute and collaborate.

Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging at GitLab

Diversity includes all the differences we each have, whether it be where we grew up, where we went to school, experiences, how we react, age, race, gender, national origin, things we can and can not see, the list goes on.

Inclusion is understanding or recognizing all these differences and inviting someone to be a part of things and collaborate, etc.

Belonging is when you feel your insights and contributions are valued. It goes back to team members feeling they can bring their full selves to work.

See the Diversity, Inclusion, and Belonging page for more information.

What inclusive behaviors look like

1. Include and seek input from team members across a wide variety of backgrounds.
1. Active listening - listen carefully to the person speaking and playback what they have said in an effort to show understanding.
1. Make a habit of asking questions.
1. If you have a strong reaction to someone, ask yourself why. Look inward.
1. Address misunderstandings and quickly resolve disagreements.
1. Make a point to understand each team member's contribution efforts and leverage them as much as possible.
1. Ensure all voices are heard. Include everyone as much as possible in discussions.
1. Assume positive intent and examine your assumptions/judgements.

See our values page for further information on inclusive language.

Inclusion Training

In December 2019, we held 3 sessions on Inclusion Training. Below you can find a recorded session that follows along with the slide deck and agenda.

{{< youtube "gsQ2OsmgqVM" >}}

Inclusion Knowledge Assessment

Anyone can earn a GitLab Inclusion Certification. To obtain certification, you will need to complete the Inclusion Knowledge Assessment Quiz and earn at least an 80%. Once the quiz has been passed, you will receive an email with your certification that you can share on your personal LinkedIn or Twitter pages. If you have questions, please reach out to our L&D team at learning@gitlab.com.

SECTION: company/culture/inclusion/ceo-dib-statement.md

To be updated

To be updated

SECTION: company/culture/inclusion/dib-communications-strategy.md

Purpose

The Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging (DIB) Team has a variety of ways that it communicates with team members from IC all the way up to e-group, this page documents the ways we do this, what information will be provided and the timing of when these communications will happen.

Encouraging Participation in Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging

DIB is a core value and is something that is measured by DIB Competencies in performance reviews, mid reviews and promotions. The DIB team is providing an easily accessible way for

team members to display the DIB value by providing on a monthly or quarterly basis depending on level, way you can contribute on a increasing scale of Good, Better & Best. This will enable team members to participate in a ways they are able to at any given time depending on competing priorities.

DRI's & Dates & Method of Communication:

- E-Group Communications -
 - DRI: Sherida McCmullan
 - Cadence: Quarterly
 - Method of Communication:
- VP+ Communications -
 - DRI: Sherida McCMullan
 - Cadence: Quarterly
 - Method of Communication: VP Direct Monthly Call
- Leadership DIB Council -
 - DRI: Liam McNally
 - Cadence: Monthly
 - Method of Communication: Leadership DIB Council Call
- People Managers Communications -
 - DRI: Liam McNally
 - Cadence: Monthly
 - Method of Communication: People-Mrgs+ Slack Channel
- Individual Contributors Communications -
 - DRI Marina Brownrigg
 - Cadence: Monthly
 - Method of Communication: While you were Iterating, What's Happening and DIB Slack Channels

Example

Good: Use monthly Zoom Background attached

Better: Promote & Attend heritage month event on XXXX

Best: Post in the people-managers-and-above around a personal story focused on your experience with regards to XXXX

Why?

We are approaching it this way to ensure that all team members have the same opportunity to contribute to Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging regardless of their capacity to contribute. This will help provide clear and concise ways that team members can live in the DIB Value

Logistics

- E-Group Communications - Reminder: week 8 of prior quarter Content Ready & Reviewed: 1 week prior to the start of the quarter Released:
- VP+ Communications - Reminder: week 8 of prior quarter Content Ready & Reviewed: 1 week prior to the start of the quarter Released: During the VP Directs Call
- Leadership DIB Council - Reminder: 1 week prior to LDC Call Content Ready & Reviewed: 3 days prior to the LDC Call: 1st week of the new month
- People Managers Communications - Reminder: 1 week prior to the start of the month Content

Ready & Reviewed: 3 days prior to the start of the month Released: During the LDC Cal,
- Individual Contributors Communications - Reminder: 1 week prior to the start of the month
Content Ready & Reviewed: 3 days prior to the start of the month Released: 1st week of the new month

DIB Monthly Initiatives Call

We host the DIB Monthly Initiatives Call to provide an opportunity for Team Members to be able to ask questions around DIB Initiatives, DIB Programming and general questions regarding DIB. We also provide a deck where we highlight everything that happened in the last month and what to look forward to.

Process

- DRI: Marina Brownrigg, DIB Partner
- 10 working days prior to the monthly DIB Initiatives call, create Issue, then tag all the TMRG and TMAG stakeholders/leads to add their updates in the linked deck prior to the call.

DIB in Q2 - PBPs Only

To ensure strong collaboration with the People Business Partner team we provide a DIB in Q2 deck that highlights the strategic imperatives of the DIB Team and any collaborations that are required.

Process

- DRI - Liam McNally, Manager, DIB
- Cadence: Quarterly
- Release for Collaboration from DIB Team: 2 weeks prior to the end of the quarter
- Delivered: First week of the new quarter
- Method of Communication: Leadership DIB Council Call DIB-PBP Slack Channel

SECTION: company/culture/inclusion/dib-goals.md

In this page you will find the current Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging Goals for GitLab. These will be updated on a quarterly basis to ensure they remain current. We will keep a list of completed or non-current goals at the bottom with a retention of 12 months. If you would like to see the history of goals going further back, you can view the evolution of the page in GitLab.

Current Goals

Geographic Diversity (Team Member representation outside of NORAM)

We do not currently have a company wide goal for Geographic Diversity and this will remain in place for FY'23. Instead we will focus on increasing Director+ representation outside of the United States as team member representation is currently outpacing leadership representation. It would not prove advantageous to take a goal to continue to increase team members external to

the United States without first focusing on increasing our leadership population external to the United States. In FY24, we will reevaluate the need for director level+ representation goals outside of the United States.

Problem Statement & Data:

What is a timeline to create a US leadership KPI and/or OKR?

Hypothesis:

- Hiring occurs predominantly in US.
- Leadership is predominantly US Centric
- We are not currently hiring in enough countries

Data:

Engineering Data: Representation in US vs. External to US

1. Breakdown by levels showed that there are proportionate of TMs at both the IC and Manager levels when comparing US to Non-US representation.

- Engineering: US: 30.2% Non-US: 69.8%

Results:

1. Based on the data provided on both the current breakdown of TMs, levels and regions for Engineering, we do not recommend creating an additional goal around increased geographic representation.

Global Representation of URGs

These breakouts are currently found here

Past Goals

Currently no past goals to attribute here

Due to data and or legal limitations, this is not an exhaustive list of all of our underrepresented groups. Those with disabilities, those that identify as LGBTQIA+, etc. who choose not to disclose or underrepresented ethnicities outside of the US.

The DIB Team is actively working on finding data sets outside the US and inclusion metrics for underrepresented groups we cannot report on as team member representation.

SECTION: company/culture/inclusion/dib-speaker-series.md

Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging Speaker Series

This is a series of Speakers, Q&As, Talk and Workshops that the Diversity, Inclusion and

Belonging Team, the DIB Advisory Board or Team Member Resource Groups organise on topics of DIB. If you have an idea for a speaker please reach out to a DIB Team Member or submit a DIB Speaker Engagement Issue Template.

Upcoming Speakers

-

Past Speakers and Events

- 26 of July 2022 - Joany Badenhorst

{{< youtube "lIFhCvClfZY" >}}

- 24th of June 2022 - Tyrance Billingsley

{{< youtube "gjo4vAFzKqk" >}}

- 19th/ 20th of October 2021 - 50 Shades of Bias with Tina, Leo and Maribel

{{< youtube "4WCZqNVz-ck" >}}

- July 19th - Neurodiversity in the Workplace with Sophie Longley

{{< youtube "KJwIDoxQeSc" >}}

- June 17th Fireside and Q&A with [Joy Gharoro-Akpotojor]

{{< youtube "r2o2im4Gvog" >}}

- May 19th 2021 GitLab Fireside chat with Shaun Christie-David - Social Entrepreneur and CEO of Plateitforward

{{< youtube "4xhj1cyG8" >}}

- April 15th 2021 GitLab x Kinspace: The importance and power of storytelling in building inclusive and intersectional workplaces

Zoom chat box as a lot of interaction here

{{< youtube "hTeyU-z7zc" >}}

- March 8th 2021 International Women's Day Event: Kathryn Jacob, Sue Unerman and Mark Edwards. Authors of The Key to Transforming and Maintaining Diversity, Inclusion and Equality at Work

{{< youtube "YNwpQITr8VM" >}}

- September 24th 2021 Sekou Kaalund - JP Morgan Chase

{{< youtube "4n8vRfVvyGE" >}}

SECTION: company/culture/inclusion/dib-sponsorship.md

Sponsorship vs Mentorship

Sponsorship

Sponsorship is defined as using your influence and/or power to advocate and positively impact the growth and career advancement of a team member. A sponsor is a senior leader with significant influence and responsibilities. A sponsor may then use this influence for activities such as:

- Advocating for career advancement opportunities
- Providing stretch opportunities to up skill via active projects
- Promoting sponsee visibility with other senior leaders
- Giving advice on "presentation of self" to sponsee
- Giving timely, honest feedback on skills, capabilities or experience gaps

At GitLab a sponsorship program can be a way of rewarding and growing top performing GitLab team members. Alternatively, it can be used to increase representation or provide visibility to underrepresented groups at GitLab, which can be seen via the Sales Sponsorship Pilot Program.

This page outlines what sponsorship is and the pathway to creating a successful sponsorship program

Mentorship

Mentorship is defined in our Mentoring handbook page: Mentor relationships are an opportunity for individuals to learn from someone's personal experience, background, and perspective. These relationships build trust on a team, provide safe space to make mistakes, and encourage both personal and professional development.

Harvard Business Review defines the difference between sponsors versus mentors: "While a mentor is someone who has knowledge and will share it with you, a sponsor is a person who has power and will use it for you."

Starting a DIB Sponsorship Program

A DIB sponsorship program can start in a variety of ways:

1. By request from a senior leader to a People Business Partner or DIB Team
1. By request of a People Business Partner as part of the departments ongoing people strategy
1. By the Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging Team as part of the ongoing DIB Strategy for that department or GitLab as a whole

When requesting a new Sponsorship Program these things should be taken into consideration

1. Bandwidth must be available to carry out the sponsorship program
1. A defined list of potential participants

1. Clear goals of the Sponsorship Program i.e; to provide growth opportunities to top performers or to increase leadership representation of a URG in the department

DIB Sponsorship Program Outline

- The program can be 6/9/12 months in duration
- Create an issue highlighting the URG or at risk group, timeframe, potential start date
- Identify and nominate Executive Sponsorship Advocates
- Identify Sponsors & agreement to participate
- Nominate Sponsees & agreement to participate
- Sponsorship Training & Education
- Sponsorship Matching Process
- Begin program
- Feedback sessions 60 days, half way, end of program
- Next steps session
- End of Program

Stakeholders: E-Group Leader, Senior Leaders, DIB Team, Learning & Development, Sponsee Managers, People Business Partners

Role of Executive Sponsorship Advocate

The Executive Sponsorship Advocates are nominated senior leaders by the E-Group Leader/PBPs/DIB Team to help evangelise the sponsorship program with their peers. They will share in the accountability for the success of the Sponsorship Program.

Roles of a Sponsor

A Sponsor is someone who has power and influence at GitLab and will use that power to advocate, elevate and impact a team member's opportunities and career progression at GitLab.

A sponsor at GitLab is:

- A Senior Leader at a minimum job grade 10+ and is not the sponsee's direct manager.
 - The senior leader should be a People Manager or Manager of Managers
- Must have been at GitLab for 6+ months
- Be able to commit to the defined duration of the sponsorship program which will include
 - Sponsor Training
 - Kick-off calls
 - Bi-weekly 1-1 with Sponsee
- Be able to fully commit and be held accountable for their role within the Sponsorship Program

As a Sponsor you should be:

- Be open and honest
- Listen and Learn
- Lean into discomfort in areas not familiar to you (e.g. cultural differences)
- Take risks with the relationship
- Advocate for your sponsee with intent

- Give feedback as appropriate
- Be intentional in building the relationship

A sponsor will:

- Use their influence and power to advocate for the sponsee potential for career advancement
- Use their influence to increase the visibility of the sponsee amongst other Senior Leaders at GitLab
- Use their influence to increase the visibility of the sponsee at GitLab
- Provide opportunities and space for risk-taking and growth
- Provide feedback on growth and skill development

The sponsorship relationship may not provide all the above but the sponsor should be willing and able to provide some of the opportunities above to the sponsor.

Role of a Sponsee

A Sponsee at GitLab will:

- Be performing in your role in accordance with your managers expectations, which take into account performance exercises such as 9 box and not on a Performance Improvement Plan
- Be nominated to take part in the Sponsorship Program
- Be able to commit to the duration of the program
- Willing to commit to the overall expectations of the program as outlined throughout the handbook page

As a Sponsee you should be:

- Be able to lead the relationship with your sponsor
- Be able take risks with the relationship
- Trust is a vital part of the relationship
- Be able to do the work required based on feedback received and requirements for success
- Be able to request and give feedback as appropriate
- Be able to take personal responsibility for your career and be empowered to ask for what you need

A Sponsee will:

- Maintain or exceed their performance record
- Maintain trust & confidentiality in the relationship
- Assist the sponsor in insights to the business and challenging perceived norms
- Be an ambassador for our CREDIT Values
- Have aspirational goals for career development; within leadership or as a senior IC
- Have a growth mindset and will be able to continually learn
- Have the ability to take on special projects which will impact their growth
- Makes themselves available for opportunities and stretch assignments
- Consistently performing at or above the performance bar

Role of Manager

- The manager will support the team member in ensuring that they have a Individual Growth Plan (IGP)
- As well reassess the IGP at regular intervals during the sponsorship program
- The manager will regularly check in on the progress of the Sponsorship Program with their report
- The manager will regularly report on the success of the program to the leadership advocates of the program
- Participate in a manager of sponsees session

The Sponsorship Process

Before you begin

Create an issue in the DIB Project to begin the process of developing the Sponsorship Program

Key Stakeholders

Identify the key stakeholders of the program, likely stakeholders will include but not limited to:

- E-Group Member
- Senior Leaders of the department
- Sponsee Managers
- People Business Partners
- DIB Team

Ensure that you operate with a high degree of communication with the key stakeholders on project timing including: Communication dates, communication templates, leadership comms etc

Timeframe

The timeframe of the program will be highly dependent on the goals of the program. We suggest a minimum of 6 months and maximum of 12 months for a formal sponsorship program. The idea is that after the formal program an informal relationship will continue with the successful matches.

Identifying Executive Sponsorship Advocates

An Executive Sponsorship Advocate should be a senior leader who has the ability to influence other team members across the department around the program.

You should work with the E-group member and People Business Partners to identify the most appropriate leaders. Consideration should be given to:

- Tenure
- Seniority
- Scope of influence
- Previous DIB related expertise
- Accountability

Identifying Sponsors

A sponsor must be able to fit within the criteria outlined above. When identifying appropriate sponsors you should:

- Consult with the People Business Partners for the department to ensure suitability
- Ensure all Sponsors meet the requirements
- Develop materials for sponsors outlining the program, taking into consideration the goals of the program, team members being sponsored, education material. You can utilize templates that already exist
- Develop a sign up form using the template
- Utilize the Executive Sponsorship Advocates to evangelize the program and encourage sign ups
- Provide a 2-3 week period for sign ups to occur

Identifying & Nominating Sponsees

When identifying sponsees, first consider the goal of the sponsorship program and set out a criteria for Sponsees. This could be; must be rated 1-3 on the 9 box performance exercise or must be a member of xx URG and performing in the role. It could also be a combination of the two.

Utilize the number of sponsors to establish how many sponsees can participate in the program. Ideally each sponsor will only have 1 sponsee however exceptions can be made where applicable.

Once a criteria has been set and the number of sponsees established, identify with senior leaders and managers who should be nominated to participate. When nominating:

- Ensure all Sponsees meet the requirements
- Develop materials for sponsees outlining the program, taking into consideration the goals of the program, team members being sponsored, education material. You can utilize templates that already exist
- Develop a sign up form using the template
- Utilize the Executive Sponsorship Advocates to evangelize the program and encourage sign ups
- Provide a 2-3 week period for sign ups to occur

Sponsorship Training & Education

Once sign ups are complete, it is important to provide training to the Sponsors and Sponsees. This should include training on:

- Accountabilities and Expectations of the program
- The responsibilities of being Sponsor or Sponsee

Accountabilities & Expectations

Sponsorship Matching Process

Once sign up has closed for the Sponsees, matching can begin. You should utilize the answers in the sign up form to match sponsees and sponsors appropriately. Other considerations include:

- The sponsor should be two job grade above the sponsee
- The sponsor should not be in the direct hierarchy of the sponsor

- Utilize the sign up form to match similar goals and experiences for the sponsee sponsor pairing

Begin the program

Sponsorship Framework

To ensure a successful sponsorship relationship, we have built out a framework on how to ensure that you ultimately achieve advocacy. This framework is not linear, you may go back steps occasionally to ensure that authentic sponsorship can occur but if you follow the process, building and maintaining trust the process will work.

Build

Take the time to build a solid relationship with each other. This will be particularly important if you have no previous direct working relationship and can often take some time to cultivate. It is very important to build the relationship first before moving into authentic sponsorship.

Suggested Actions:

- Commit to regular 1-1s
- Understand the sponsees career development plan
- Set goals and expectations early

Develop

You have taken the time to build a relationship with each other, the next step is to develop that relationship by becoming action & capability focussed. In this step the sponsor will help guide the sponsee on areas of improvement in skills & capabilities. The sponsee is responsible for acting on feedback and being intentional about displaying these improvements to the sponsor.

Suggested Actions:

- Find and seek opportunities for the sponsor to observe the sponsees improvement areas
- Sponsee invites Sponsor to a team meeting where they are presenting
- Sponsor invites sponsee to a working group

Commit

This is where both parties agree to move forward with the next step, which is sponsorship and advocating for the sponsee. This can take many forms, such as; a formal discussion, the sponsor outlining actions to the sponsee or at the sponsees request. This is an opportunity to provide feedback, any uncertainties and to reestablish career development goals.

Suggested Actions:

- Participate in feedback session with sponsee

Advocate

Now that a commitment has been made and the sponsor is satisfied that the sponsee is ready for the next step. The sponsor actively and intentionally advocates for sponsees continued career development and advancement at GitLab.

Feedback Process

There should be a series of feedback touch points during the program.

- 60 days - this should evaluate the strength of the matches, discover any additional resources that are required and remedy any issues early.
- Mid Way - this should evaluate what stage the sponsorship relationship is at, if the commitments are still being met and provide some additional encouragement to move the relationship forward.
- End of program - this should evaluate the effectiveness of the full program, any results that were achieved and an opportunity to gather iteration data.

Program Resources

- Agenda Template
- Sample emails and slack messages
- Successful Sponsorship Relationship Video
- Reminder resources

Communication Resources

Throughout the program, the program lead and Executive Sponsorship Advocates should communicate regularly with the participants. A great way of doing this is providing regular resources on sponsorship activities. Here is a list of helpful resources that you can use:

End of Program

At the end of the program, we will conduct feedback sessions as above. We will also conduct a Next Step Plan.

This will solidify any expectations for after the program, whether that is to enter a more informal sponsorship program, on going advocacy for career development or growth.

Goals & Benefits

Goals:

The goals of including Sponsorship Programs at GitLab is to help ensure that our top performers and team members from underrepresented groups are giving increased opportunities to work with senior leaders. This will increase engagement within these groups and ultimately increase the retention of team members.

Benefits:

Sponsor:

- Exposure to a diverse set of team members at GitLab, increasing their ability to lead diverse teams
- Exposure to new ideas and be challenged on the status quo
- Intentional talent management & succession planning
- Better understanding of the challenges of team members from underrepresented groups

Sponsee:

- Increased exposure to GitLab and visibility to senior leaders at GitLab
- Access to feedback from a senior leader
- Ability to develop skills and capabilities
- Increased control over your career development plan

GitLab:

- A more diverse team at leadership team
- Increased retention of team members
- Attraction of underrepresented groups to GitLab
- Team members more motivated to maintain performance levels

Suggested measureables

All programs should have some form of measurable for success, below are a few examples.

- Engagement survey data for the group
- Retention data for the group
- Team Member Experience Interview Data
- Program Satisfaction
- Career Advancement/Mobility of participants

Training Videos & Materials

- Training Slides
- Kick Off Call Slides

Informal Sponsorship Relationships

Sponsorship doesn't have to happen in the confines of a formal program. You may have a desire to sponsor a team member but no program exists as yet. This is something that is encouraged and we have seen happen successfully in the past, you can view this video as an example.

When entering an informal sponsorship relationship be sure to still outline and discuss the goals of the sponsorship. Follow the Sponsorship Framework to ensure success and hold each other accountable.

This will ensure a great experience for both the sponsor and sponsee.

SECTION: company/culture/inclusion/engineering-initiatives.md

This page is in draft. We are working to build out this page and gather all the running initiatives/partnerships in Engineering.

Engineering Inclusion and Accessibility Initiatives

At GitLab, Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging is infused into our company culture, from our values to our all-remote way of working.

Engineering partners closely with our Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging team to ensure we're building a diverse and inclusive workforce around the globe as the company continues to grow.

- Team Member Resource Groups
- Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging GitLab initiatives

Overview

At GitLab, fostering an inclusive and accessible engineering environment is integral to our mission of enabling everyone to contribute. By embedding accessibility and inclusive practices into our engineering processes, we enhance innovation, improve product quality, and meet the diverse needs of our global user base.

Strategic Focus Areas

Our engineering DIB strategy aligns with GitLab's A.D.A.P.T model while focusing on three key pillars:

1. DNA (Disability, Neurodiversity, and Accessibility) Integration

At GitLab, DNA aims to integrate disability, neurodiversity, and accessibility into all aspects of the company - from product design to talent acquisition, team member education, and culture through TMRG engagement. Using the ARISE ([link to follow](#)) framework transforms GitLab's DNA strategy into actionable initiatives

Key Goals:

- Integrate Accessibility in Communications and Product Strategy
- Implement Accessibility Technologies
- Strengthen People & Talent Processes
- Develop Allyship through Education
- Enhance TMRG Engagement and Allyship

2. Global Inclusion and Regional Initiatives

GitLab's global DIB strategy focuses on creating an inclusive environment that spans our worldwide workforce. Our regional initiatives are tailored to address specific needs across APAC-J, EMEA, and the Americas, with particular emphasis on expanding representation and developing inclusive leadership. Key priorities include launching our comprehensive accessibility strategy and enhancing our Team Member Resource Groups (TMRGs) to better support

our global team members. We're also focused on strengthening regional programs that reflect local needs while maintaining alignment with our global objectives.

3. Career Development

GitLab's career development strategy focuses on creating pathways for advancement across all levels of the organization. We're emphasizing inclusive leadership development through training programs and coaching, while expanding mentorship opportunities for underrepresented groups. Additionally, we're working to ensure our talent management processes support career progression through systematic audits and clear development frameworks.

Goals and Objectives

FY26 Programs in Development

Placeholders for FY26 Programs:

The following sections will be updated once our FY26 strategy is finalized. These placeholders represent key focus areas and anticipated initiatives.

[Program Placeholder 1: Accessibility Champions Program]

Description: Outline for empowering team members to lead accessibility efforts.

[Program Placeholder 2: Inclusive Practices Series]

Description: Framework for quarterly sessions showcasing inclusive engineering practices.

[Program Placeholder 3: Accessible Events Toolkit]

Description: Initial draft guidance for planning inclusive events, virtual and hybrid.

[Program Placeholder 4: [Insert Program Name]]

Description: Reserved for additional programs under development.

How to Get Involved

We invite all GitLab team members to contribute to these initiatives:

- Share feedback or ideas in the inclusion Slack channel.
- Volunteer for the Accessibility Champions Program (details forthcoming).
- Suggest improvements by opening an issue in the GitLab DIB repository.

Next Steps

We will continue updating this page as programs and initiatives are finalized. Our goal is to ensure that inclusion and accessibility remain integral to our engineering processes and culture.

For questions or suggestions, please contact the DIB team.

SECTION: company/culture/inclusion/erg-gitlab-diversability.md

Mission

The GitLab Disability & Neurodivergence TMRG is a resource group to aid team members through their lived experiences at GitLab. Whether these experiences are seen or unseen, present themselves as a physical or a mental diversity, or directly impact you or a loved one, our goal is to intentionally build inclusive practices throughout the company as well as to act as a support system to team members who may want to be in a community with others who share similar experiences.

The Disability & Neurodivergence TMRG advocates for every team member for physical conditions related to sight, sound, and/or mobility or for mental health concerns like ADHD, anxiety, depression and so much more. These are just a few examples of the lived experiences our team members could have at GitLab that can be better positioned with consideration and inclusion as part of the hiring, onboarding, and day-to-day processes as well as before, during, and after a project, a meeting, a conference, or even when we have big company-wide changes.

How we accomplish our mission

First, we work with teams to intentionally consider how changes and experiences could impact team members, helping to ensure team members receive the support and tools necessary to be successful, whatever that may be. This helps to reduce the volume of "reactive" updates that need to be made. Think of our team experience at Contribute. We'll be planning ahead of our time together to make sure we're considering our lived experiences and that our onsite time at Contribute is as inclusive as possible.

Also, we act as a support group. Whether it's async in Slack or live during a meeting or panel conversation, we'll present members of our community, both from inside and outside of GitLab, to transparently discuss their experiences. Not just how they cope, but how they thrive.

Leads

- Dominique Top
- James Hebden
- James Moverly
- Flavia Costa
- Jess Perry

Executive Sponsor

- Rob Allen - VP of People

Upcoming Events

- Join our ongoing group coffee chat invites by signing up [here](#)

- Join the neurodiverse-coffee-chat Slack channel to randomly connect one-to-one in a "donut" coffee chat

Additional Resources

Neurodivergence is considered a disability? Yes

When we are talking about a disability, we are referring to any physical or mental condition that limits a major life activity, or a history of such a condition. This includes ADHD, Dyslexia, Autism, and other cognitive disabilities, as well as mental health concerns such as depression or anxiety and physical conditions. We often refer to people with cognitive disabilities as being neurodivergent or having a neurodivergence (many people prefer "people first language use" and you can learn more about it [here](#)).

Disclosing your disability to your team and GitLab

Disclosing your disability is an entirely personal choice. Disclosure is not required. However, we aim to live our Transparency value and to ensure that all team members have an equitable opportunity to succeed in their role, and disclosure could aid in this.

You don't have to be specific about your diagnosis. An employer may ask for verification from a doctor but it can just say you have a disability and need some accommodation. You are not required to share health details if you don't want to.

Formal disclosure of your disability

If you believe you need to request reasonable accommodations to succeed at GitLab, please notify the Team Member Relations team at teammemberrelations@gitlab.com. The Job Accommodation Network (JAN) site has great resources, questions to consider, and examples of types of accommodations. For example, the AD/HD page. The Company will work with each individual to define their job-related or application-related needs and to try to accommodate those needs according to the GitLab Individuals with Disabilities Policy.

Informal disclosure of your disability, or simply notifying your team or manager

If you do not believe you need to request reasonable accommodations and you are just looking to update your manager or your team, you can do so freely when you feel is right. A 1:1 with your manager would be a good place to start so that if and when you choose to share with other team members, your manager has already been briefed.

Not sure about disclosure? The Disability and Neurodivergence TMRG is here to listen and guide

Determining whether or not to disclose your disability at work is a deeply personal choice. If you would like to chat with someone about it discreetly, please feel free to DM the leads on Slack and they can either chat with you directly or point you to someone else who might be a better fit for the discussion.

SECTION: company/culture/inclusion/erg-guide.md

On this page you will be provided an overview of what is needed to start and sustain a GitLab TMRG (Team Member Resource Group) or a Team Member Advocacy Group.

Definition of the TMRG - Team Member Resource Groups

TMRGs are voluntary, team member-led groups focused on fostering diversity, inclusion and belonging within GitLab. These groups help team members build stronger internal and external connections; offer social, educational, and outreach activities; create development opportunities for future leaders; and increase engagement among team members.

Team Member Resource Group provide support for an underrepresented group

- The purpose for this type of TMRG is to develop and elevate that underrepresented group within GitLab. To provide a voice and a safe space for people who identify as a part of that group and their allies. With aim of increasing and developing the sense of belonging.

Team Member Advocacy Group

- Team Member Advocacy Groups focus on Inclusion & Belonging of a demographic or social issue that sits outside of URGs and does not focus on team member representation.

What is not an TMRG at GitLab

There are many types of groups and not all of them meet the criteria of being a GitLab supported TMRG. Here are some examples of those that would not be considered TMRGs here at GitLab:

- Groups formed for the purpose of opposing other groups
- Groups formed to promote political affiliations
- Groups formed around strictly social activities
- Groups of passion such as those formed around a passion for coffee, exercise, book reading, photography, etc.

NOTE: "GitLab supported TMRG" means the group is formally recognized by the company as a GitLab TMRG.

How to Join Current TMRGs and TMAGs Slack Channels

The following groups have completed the process to be an TMRG or TMAG and received formal support as part of the DIB framework. Click the signup link (GitLab team members only) to join:

Ordered alphabetically to avoid the perception that any TMRG or TMAG is more important than any other.

| TMRG or TMAG | Team Leaders | Slack Channel | Sign Up | Ongoing TMRG or TMAG Agenda | Executive Sponsor |

| ----- | ----- | ----- | ----- | ----- | ----- |

| GitLab API - Asia Pacific Islander | Christopher Wang, Steve Xu, Sheela Viswanathan, Robin Falkowski | api-tmrgr | Sign up for future meetings (Google group) | API Agenda | Nabitha Rao |

| GitLab Disability and Neurodivergence | James Hebden, Dominique Top, James Moverley , Flavia

Costa | disability-and-neurodivergence-tmrg | Sign up for future meetings (google form) |
 DiversABILITY Agenda | Rob Allen |
 | GitLab Generational Understanding | Miles Russell, Terri Chu | generationalunderstanding |
 Sign up for future meetings (Google group) | Generational Understanding Agenda | Tim Zallmann |
 | GitLab Mental Health TMAG | Yin Yu, Matthew Macfarlane | mental-health-tmag | Sign up for
 future meetings (Google group) | Mental Health Agenda | Lisa Boughner |
 | Global Voices | Eliran Mesika, Charlie Ablett | global-voices-tmrg | Sign up for future
 meetings (Google group) | TBD | Sabrina Farmer |
 | GitLab Gente | Pilar Mejia, Romer Gonzalez, Giuliana Lucchesi | gente | Sign up for future
 meetings (Google group) | Gente Agenda | Josh Lemos |
 | Black @ GitLab | Darren Eastman, Erran Carey, Madou Coulibaly | black-at-gitlab | Sign up
 for future meetings (Google group) | Black @ GitLab Agenda | David DeSanto |
 | GitLab Pride | Alex Hanselka and Andrew Chapman | lgbtq | Sign up for future meetings (Google
 group) | Pride Agenda | Robin Schulman |
 | GitLab Women | Winnie Chan, Gosia Ksionek, Sara Cuesta | women | Sign up for future meetings
 (google group) | Women Agenda | Robin Schulman |
 | GitLab Caregivers | Jackie Porter, Gena Schwam | caregivers-tmrg | TBA | Caregivers Agenda |
 Wendy Barnes |

Executive Sponsorship

An Executive Sponsor can be any leader at GitLab who is at VP level or above. The role of an executive sponsor is to support the development of the TMRG, provide advocacy at the leadership level, connect the TMRG to GitLab's mission & goals and provide mentorship to TMRG leaders.

Requirements:

- An executive sponsor does not have to be a member of the underrepresented group but has the capacity to be an ally to the group
- Be able to offer a time commitment to the TMRG both sync and async
- Have the capacity to learn more about the underrepresented group if they are unfamiliar with the needs of the group
- Have taken the psychological safety course

Accountabilities and Commitments:

- Provide TMRG leads with key business insights (eg., Company OKRs) and ensure leads understand the company's strategic vision
- Allocate time to TMRG leaders (bi-monthly or as agreed upon with TMRG leads) to understand TMRG needs and resources
- Advocate for the TMRG with DIB team and E-Group to gain leadership buy-in
- Provide leadership guidance to TMRG leads when goals are misaligned to company or DIB goals
- Provide TMRG updates to E-Group once/quarter with the assistance of DIB Team
- Minimum one year commitment
- If you are no longer able to maintain these Accountabilities and Commitments you should let the DIB team know as soon as possible.

Choosing an Executive Sponsor:

- Any E-Group member with the capacity to be an executive sponsor for a TMRG will be the first

to be allocated as an executive sponsor. E-Group members should only be an executive sponsor to one TMRG but this is not a hard and fast rule.

- If an E-Group Member is not available for executive sponsorship, TMRG leaders can identify a VP level team member to be their executive sponsor. This nomination by the TMRG must be approved by the E-Group in the E-Group weekly meeting.
- Alternatively, the TMRG can ask the DIB Team to identify a suitable Executive Sponsor. Upon which the DIB Team will ask the E-Group (Via the E-Group Weekly Meeting) for recommendations from their Direct Reports who are at VP level who could be suitable executive sponsors.
- The Chief of Staff to the CEO or the Chief People Officer will ensure that this is added to the agenda of the E-Group Weekly Meeting when the situation occurs.

The Importance of Executive Sponsorship

Being a Diverse Business is important for business success

Being a diverse business has been shown to greatly benefit a business on multiple fronts, with Talent, Investors and Customers all wanting to see clear and meaningful impact. Here are some interesting insights from a number of reports:

The McKinsey latest report Diversity Wins provided some amazing insights into how diversity can enhance business performance had some interesting and exciting statistics:

- Top quartile on gender diversity meant a 25% likelihood of financial outperformance than the bottom quartile
- Top quartile on ethnic diversity meant a 36% likelihood of financial outperformance than the bottom quartile

The Deloitte 2021 Global Human Capital Trends: Special report also provided some great insights into h